

PARTS OF SPEECH

Detailed English Language Notes for Secondary School Students

Meaning of Parts of Speech

Parts of speech are the different groups into which words are divided according to their functions in a sentence.

They help us understand how words are used in communication.

There are eight main parts of speech:

1. Noun
 2. Pronoun
 3. Verb
 4. Adjective
 5. Adverb
 6. Preposition
 7. Conjunction
 8. Interjection
-

1. NOUN

Meaning of a Noun

A noun is a naming word.

It names a person, animal, place, thing, or idea.

Types of Nouns

A. Proper Noun

A proper noun is the specific name of a person, place, or thing.

Examples:

- Lagos
- Nigeria
- Emeka
- Monday

Proper nouns begin with capital letters.

B. Common Noun

A common noun refers to general names.

Examples:

- boy
 - city
 - school
 - river
-

c. Concrete Noun

Concrete nouns can be seen or touched.

Examples:

- table
 - phone
 - dog
 - water
-

D. Abstract Noun

Abstract nouns cannot be touched or seen physically.

Examples:

- honesty
 - love
 - wisdom
 - happiness
-

E. Collective Noun

A collective noun refers to a group.

Examples:

- team
 - crowd
 - class
 - committee
-

Examples in Sentences

- Chinedu bought a new phone.
 - The team won the match.
 - Honesty is important.
-

Practice Questions

1. Underline the nouns in this sentence:

"The teacher entered the classroom."

2. State the type of noun in each:

- happiness
- Abuja
- flock
- student

3. Write five proper nouns.

2. PRONOUN

Meaning of a Pronoun

A pronoun is a word used in place of a noun.

Examples

- he
 - she
 - it
 - they
 - we
 - him
-

Types of Pronouns

A. Personal Pronouns

Examples:

- I
- you
- he
- she
- they

Sentence:

- She is reading.
-

B. Possessive Pronouns

Examples:

- mine
- yours
- theirs

Sentence:

- The bag is mine.
-

C. Reflexive Pronouns

Examples:

- myself
- herself
- themselves

Sentence:

- He hurt himself.
-

D. Demonstrative Pronouns

Examples:

- this
- that
- these
- those

Sentence:

- These are my books.
-

E. Relative Pronouns

Examples:

- who
- whom
- whose
- which

Sentence:

- The boy who came yesterday is my friend.
-

Practice Questions

1. Replace the underlined noun with a pronoun:
"Ngozi is singing."

2. Identify the pronouns:

- They are coming tomorrow.
- This is my pen.

3. Write four possessive pronouns.

3. VERB

Meaning of a Verb

A verb is an action word or a doing word.

It tells us what the subject is doing.

Examples

- run
- eat
- jump
- write
- sleep

Sentence:

- Musa kicked the ball.
-

Types of Verbs

A. Action Verbs

Examples:

- dance

- cook
- read

Sentence:

- The girl danced well.
-

B. Linking Verbs

These connect the subject to more information.

Examples:

- is
- are
- was
- seem

Sentence:

- The soup is hot.
-

C. Helping Verbs

Helping verbs assist the main verb.

Examples:

- has
- have
- will
- shall

Sentence:

- She has finished her work.
-

Verb Tenses

Present Tense

Shows current action.

Examples:

- I eat rice.
 - She sings well.
-

Past Tense

Shows completed action.

Examples:

- They played football.
 - He went home.
-

Future Tense

Shows future action.

Examples:

- We shall travel tomorrow.
 - She will come later.
-

Practice Questions

1. Underline the verbs:

- The baby cried loudly.
- They are playing outside.

2. Change to past tense:

- go
- eat
- write

3. Write five action verbs.

4. ADJECTIVE

Meaning of an Adjective

An adjective describes or qualifies a noun or pronoun.

It tells us more about a person, place, or thing.

Examples

- tall boy
 - beautiful girl
 - red car
 - honest student
-

Types of Adjectives

A. Adjective of Quality

Shows quality.

Examples:

- beautiful
 - clever
 - strong
-

B. Adjective of Quantity

Shows amount.

Examples:

- little
 - enough
 - much
-

C. Adjective of Number

Shows number or position.

Examples:

- two
 - first
 - many
-

D. Demonstrative Adjective

Examples:

- this
- that
- these

Sentence:

- This book is interesting.
-

Practice Questions

1. Identify the adjectives:
 - The tall man spoke loudly.
 - She bought three oranges.
 2. Use these adjectives in sentences:
 - beautiful
 - small
 - intelligent
-

5. ADVERB

Meaning of an Adverb

An adverb modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb.

It tells us:

- how
 - when
 - where
 - to what extent
-

Examples

- quickly

- slowly
- yesterday
- very

Sentence:

- The boy ran quickly.
-

Types of Adverbs

A. Adverb of Manner

Tells how something happens.

Examples:

- slowly
 - carefully
 - loudly
-

B. Adverb of Time

Tells when something happens.

Examples:

- today
 - tomorrow
 - yesterday
-

C. Adverb of Place

Tells where something happens.

Examples:

- here
 - there
 - outside
-

D. Adverb of Degree

Shows extent.

Examples:

- very
 - too
 - almost
-

Practice Questions

1. Identify the adverbs:
 - She sang beautifully.
 - We arrived early.
 2. State the type of adverb:
 - quickly
 - tomorrow
 - outside
-

6. PREPOSITION

Meaning of a Preposition

A preposition shows the relationship between a noun or pronoun and another word.

Examples

- in
- on
- under
- beside
- between

Sentence:

- The bag is on the table.
-

Common Prepositions

Preposition Example

in in the room

on on the chair

under under the bed

beside beside the river

Practice Questions

1. Fill in the gaps:

- The cat is ____ the table.
- She sat ____ me.

2. Write five prepositions.

7. CONJUNCTION

Meaning of a Conjunction

A conjunction joins words, phrases, or sentences.

Examples

- and
- but
- because
- although
- or

Sentence:

- James and John are friends.
-

Types of Conjunctions

A. Coordinating Conjunctions

Examples:

- and
- but
- or

Sentence:

- She is smart but lazy.

B. Subordinating Conjunctions

Examples:

- because
- although
- since

Sentence:

- He stayed home because he was sick.
-

Practice Questions

1. Identify the conjunctions:
 - I came early because I was ready.
 - Mary and Jane are sisters.
 2. Join these sentences using a conjunction:
 - I was tired. I continued reading.
-

8. INTERJECTION

Meaning of an Interjection

An interjection expresses sudden emotion or feeling.

Examples

- wow!
- oh!

- alas!
- hurrah!

Sentence:

- Wow! That was amazing.
-

Types of Feelings Expressed

Feeling	Example
Joy	Hurrah!
Surprise	Oh!
Pain	Ouch!
Sorrow	Alas!

Practice Questions

1. Identify the interjections:
 - Hurrah! We won the match.
 - Oh! I forgot my book.
 2. Write two interjections showing:
 - joy
 - surprise
-

SUMMARY TABLE OF PARTS OF SPEECH

Part of Speech Function		Example
Noun	Names	boy
Pronoun	Replaces noun	he
Verb	Shows action	run
Adjective	Describes noun	tall
Adverb	Modifies verb	quickly
Preposition	Shows relationship under	
Conjunction	Joins words	and
Interjection	Expresses emotion wow!	

GENERAL EXERCISE

Identify the parts of speech of the underlined words:

1. The beautiful girl danced gracefully.
 2. They arrived yesterday.
 3. Wow! The food tastes delicious.
 4. Chinedu and Musa travelled to Abuja.
 5. The pen is under the chair.
-

STUDY TIPS FOR PARTS OF SPEECH

1. Learn the function of each part of speech.
2. Practice identifying words in sentences daily.
3. Read English passages and pick out examples.

4. Memorize examples for each category.
5. Practice sentence construction regularly.
6. Understand meanings instead of cramming definitions.
7. Solve WAEC, NECO, and JAMB English questions often.